

From 3D to real photo

For architects and interior designers

From 3D to real photo

Your clients still get grey boxes and have to imagine the rest. This is the exact way we turn a plain model into an image they approve at first sight, from the words we write to the check we run before sending it.

3D model



Final image



What you need

A Claude account to build or fix the 3D, and a Higgsfield plan with Nano Banana Pro for the images. A model from SketchUp, Revit or Rhino helps, but the measurements of the room are enough.

How to read it

Every chapter ends with something you can use the same day: a prompt to copy, a list to check or a table to keep open. The full prompt files and the delivery checklist come with the three playbooks together.

01 Prepare the model the AI reads best

02 The 8 things to name in every interior

03 The words that make a picture look AI

04 Light, camera and materials by their real names

05 The check before an image leaves the studio

06 How to price it: our real price list



Chapter 01

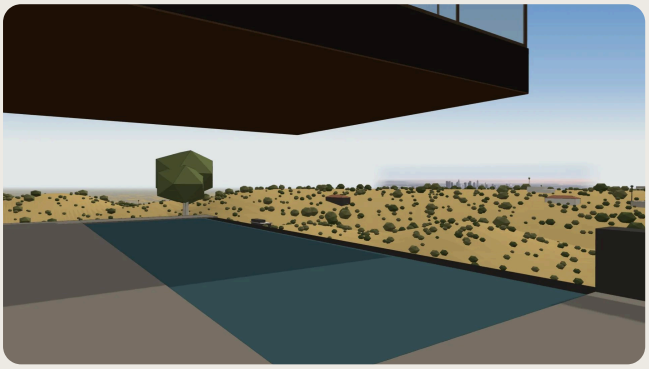
Prepare the model the way the AI reads it

The AI keeps what it can read in your 3D and makes up the rest. A clean model with the right proportions gives you an image you don't have to argue with. No SketchUp? Give Claude the measurements and it builds the 3D.

What the AI reads in a 3D

Nano Banana Pro looks at your screenshot the way you look at a photo. It keeps the edges, the openings, the heights and where the big pieces stand. It struggles with what it can't see clearly: dark glass, a corner in deep shadow, a chair hidden behind a table. So the model has one job, which is to show the geometry clearly from the camera you are going to use.

3D model



Final image



Casa Cresta, Los Angeles. The edge of the pool, the overhang and the line of the hills come straight from the 3D. The water, the stone and the light come from the prompt.

If you already have a model SketchUp, Revit, Rhino, Archicad

- **Hide what isn't part of the picture:** section boxes, grids, dimension lines, people, cars and placeholder trees. The AI copies the 3D, including the grey cubes you left as placeholders.
- **Furniture at its real size.** A sofa that is 30 cm too short comes back 30 cm too short, and the room looks wrong without anyone knowing why.
- **Glass almost clear.** In our 3D the glass sits at 16% opacity. With dark glass the AI can't see out, so it invents the view.
- **Railings below eye level** where you want the view. On one of our test villas the terrace railing sat at the height of the eyes and the city disappeared behind it.
- **Export at 3:2, at least 2000 px wide,** with two-point perspective, so the vertical lines stay straight.
- **White is fine, real textures are better.** If you have high-resolution scans of the real stone and wood, use them. A marble drawn with flat lines in the 3D comes back looking drawn.

No SketchUp Claude builds the 3D

You describe the room in metres and Claude writes a 3D scene that runs in the browser, built with three.js. You turn the camera with the mouse and take a screenshot of the view you like. Every house in our reels starts this way.

Prompt — Claude

Build a 3D model of a living room in three.js, in a single HTML page. Units are metres.
Room 9 × 6 m, ceiling 3.2 m. The long south wall is floor-to-ceiling glass in single panels with thin dark frames, glass at 16% opacity. On the opposite wall a TV wall 4 m wide in a dark stone colour, with a low cabinet 3 m long under the TV.
Sofa 340 × 100 cm, seat height 42 cm, two metres from the glass, facing the TV. Coffee table 160 × 90 cm, 35 cm high. Dining table 300 × 110 cm for ten, on the kitchen side. Ceiling of wooden slats with three dark beams.
Sun from the south-west at four in the afternoon, soft shadows. Orbit camera at eye height 1.6 m with a 24 mm lens.
Add a key that saves the current view as a 3:2 PNG with straight vertical lines. Use real catalogue sizes for every piece and list any size you had to guess.

In claude.ai the page opens next to the chat, where saving files is blocked, so take a screenshot of the view (on a Mac, Cmd + Shift + 4). With Claude Code on your own computer the save key works and the PNG lands in your folder.

Then ask for changes in plain words, one at a time: "move the sofa 40 cm toward the glass", "make the beams 30 cm deeper", "put the camera in the corner by the kitchen, looking at the window".

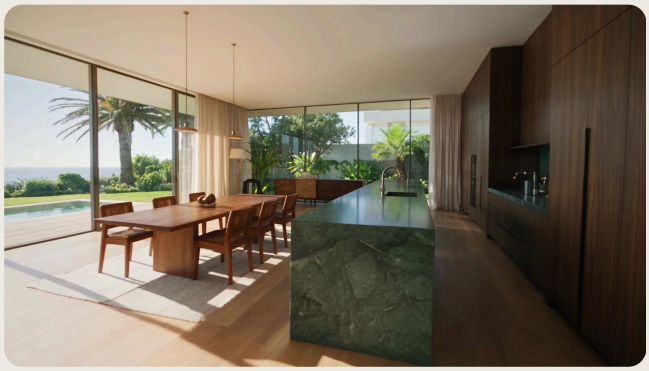
The rules that saved us the most time

1. **Real sizes from catalogues, within 3 cm.** On the Cape Town villa we checked every measure in the browser console before taking a single screenshot.
2. **Big glass in single panes.** Glass split by many frames comes back looking like an office.
3. **Real rooms.** One endless open space looks like a hotel lobby. Kitchen, living and dining should read as three places.
4. **A full house.** Rugs, lamps and a few pieces on the shelves. A room that is empty in the 3D comes back empty.
5. **Only the rooms you will show.** Model what the camera sees and stop there. Building the guest bathroom for a film that never goes in it is a day lost.

3D model



Final image



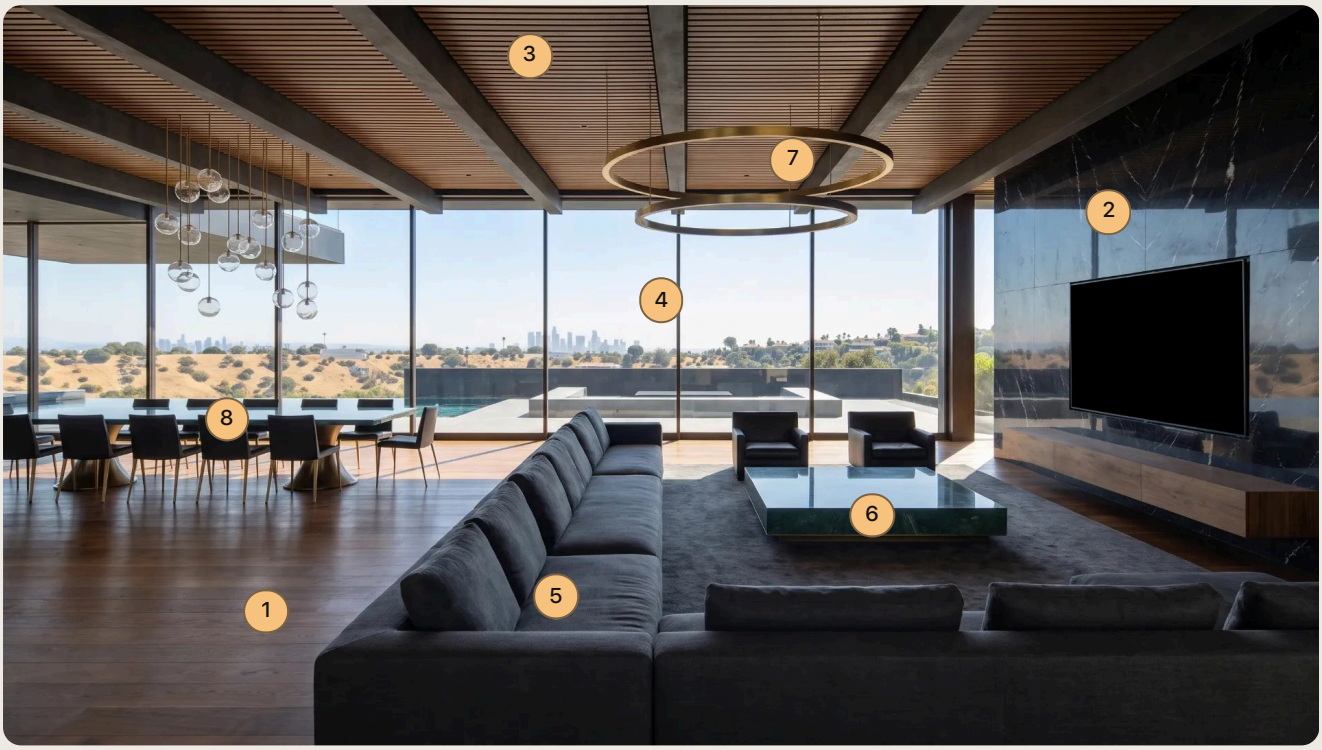


Chapter 02

The 8 things to name in every interior

Whatever you leave out of the prompt, the model fills with its own default. In our tests a living room with no furniture written came back with a travertine table, a tray of books, a linen sofa and linen curtains, all beige.

Casa Cresta, Los Angeles the eight things, one by one



1 **Floor**
wide-plank fumed oak, oiled, deep honey-brown

2 **Walls**
book-matched Nero Marquina slabs, floor to ceiling

3 **Ceiling**
oak slats between dark plaster beams, 3.4 m high

4 **Windows**
single uninterrupted panes, slim dark bronze frames

5 **Main piece**
a long low sectional in charcoal heavy linen

6 **Table**
a low square coffee table in Verde Guatemala

7 **Lamp**
two brass ring pendants on long cables

8 **Objects**
one, or write that the table tops are bare

How to write each one

Each line below is a sentence you can copy and change between the brackets. Write the colour of every surface you name, because a surface without a colour comes back beige. Once a piece has its sentence, use the same sentence in every prompt of the project, so the sofa in the wide view is the same sofa in the close-up.

Thing	Write it like this
Floor	"wide-plank fumed oak floor, oiled, deep honey-brown" · "honed Grigio Carnico dark grey marble floor" · "fine Venetian terrazzo with small marble chips in *dark green*"
Walls	"book-matched *stone* slabs floor to ceiling" · "fumed oak panelling with bronze reveals" · "marmorino plaster in deep chocolate, soft cloudy sheen" on one wall only
Ceiling	"a ceiling of fumed oak slats between dark plaster beams, 3.4 m high" · "a coffered ceiling in dark-stained oak". Always write the height.
Windows	"floor-to-ceiling glass in single uninterrupted panels, ultra-clear low-iron glass, slim dark bronze frames" · curtains: "full-height sheer curtains in smoke-grey silk organza, gathered at the far edge of the glass"
Main piece	"a long low tailored sofa, 340 cm, crisp straight cushions upholstered in *fabric and colour*, slim dark bronze base". The bed, the island or the bath in other rooms.
Table	"a low rectangular coffee table 160 × 90 cm, top in honed *stone*, thin blackened steel frame" · "an oval dining table 300 cm, top in *stone*, sculpted dark bronze base"
Lamp	A pendant or a sculptural piece where the room can take it, plus a floor or table lamp with its cable: "a cluster of hand-blown glass globes on bronze rods, hung at different heights"
Objects	One thing, useful to the place: "car keys on a leather tray on the entrance console". Or write "the table top is bare".

> **Name the maker and the model when you can,** then write the shape, the size, the material and the colour anyway. "Minotti Hamilton" alone gets you a generic sofa. "A long low tailored sofa like Minotti Hamilton, 340 cm, crisp straight cushions in charcoal wool, slim dark bronze base" gets you that sofa.

Outside five things

For exteriors, name the facade, the paving, the water, the outdoor furniture and the plants. Sky and light come from the light paragraph in chapter 4.

Facade	"board-formed concrete in warm grey with formwork marks, blackened steel frames, American black walnut soffits"
Paving	"large stepping slabs of grey Basaltina set in low groundcover" · "oiled teak decking silvering at the edges"
Water	"a pool lined in dark Basaltina, the water a dark mirror" · "a pool lined in green Sukabumi stone, the water a soft jade"
Furniture	"two sunloungers in dark teak with *colour* cushions, set apart on the left of the pool". Two, never a row of six.
Plants	Name the species, in three layers: "a California sycamore and coast live oaks, tall Canary Island palms, clusters of Agave attenuata planted in the ground"

The default kit what comes back when you don’t name it

These are the pieces the model reaches for when the prompt leaves a gap. If you find them in your image and you didn’t write them, something is missing from the prompt.

- A deep sofa in beige linen or bouclé, round or plinth tables in travertine, a tray with books, a stone bowl and a candle.
- White linen curtains blowing, a jute rug, fluted panels on the island and the walls.
- An olive tree in a pot, a monstera, pampas grass, dry branches in a vase.
- Mushroom lamps, paper lanterns, a row of opal globes.
- Beige, cream, greige and taupe on every soft surface, with smooth white plaster on the walls.



Chapter 03

The words that make a picture look AI

Some words don't describe anything in the room. The model reads them as "make it look like a render", and that's exactly what it does.

Words we never write and what goes in their place

Never	What happens	Write instead
8k, ultra realistic, hyperrealistic, photorealistic, masterpiece, award-winning, trending, octane, unreal, V-Ray, PBR	These are render and contest words, so you get a render	The closing line at the end of this chapter
luxury, high-end, quiet luxury, statement piece, curated	Too vague to draw, so the model picks its default	The maker, the model, the material and the size
cozy, warm and inviting, serene, dreamy, ethereal, spa-like	Mood words turn into beige and haze	The colour of every surface
Japandi, organic modern, boho, minimalist, Scandinavian	Style labels pull the whole default kit at once	The pieces themselves, one by one
soft lighting, cinematic lighting, golden hour, volumetric, god rays, dramatic sky	The sunset filter you have seen a thousand times	Where the sun is, what time it is, where the shadows fall
neutral tones, earthy tones, muted, low contrast, flat light, overcast	Grey-beige from wall to wall	Named colours on named surfaces
vivid, vibrant, saturated, turquoise, crystal clear, electric, deep cobalt	Turquoise water and orange skies	"the water a dark mirror", "the water a soft jade"
white walls, abstract art, plants	The model's own version of each	A named stone, an artist's spirit, a species

Write it the way you want it

Nano Banana, Seedream and GPT Image read the nouns and draw them, even when a "no" comes before them. On one of our concept houses "no rows of identical white sunbeds" produced exactly a row of identical white sunbeds. So the prompt only describes what you want to see.

Gets you the problem

no plastic look · without curtains · avoid clutter · no plants inside · no people

Gets you the picture

honed stone with visible micro-texture and slight wear · bare floor-to-ceiling glass, curtains hidden in a ceiling pocket · the table top is bare

Video is the one exception. Seedance and Kling add sparkles and floating dust on their own, so at the end of every video prompt we write the opposite out loud. You will find that line in Playbook 02.

The closing line

Every image prompt we write ends with the same sentence. It tells the model what kind of photograph this is without using a single word from the table above.

Closing line — Nano Banana Pro

Editorial architecture photograph in the spirit of photographer, natural colour like a Kodak Portra 400 film scan, gentle highlight roll-off, fine film grain.

For the photographer, pick someone whose work fits the house: Hélène Binet for stone and shadow, Fernando Guerra for white modern villas, Joe Fletcher for California houses on the hillside. The model has seen their pictures, and it tends to borrow the way they frame and expose.



Chapter 04

Light, camera, materials by their real names

A photographer decides where to stand, which lens to use and where the sun is. Write those three things down and the picture stops looking generated.

Camera

Room	Lens
Small room, under 15 m²	24 to 35 mm
Standard room	24 to 28 mm
Large open space	18 to 24 mm
Lobby, hotel hall	14 to 24 mm
Anything	never below 14 mm

- **Height 1.5 to 1.7 m,** the height of the eyes. Go down to 0.9 to 1.2 m to give height to a ceiling or to frame the seats. In kitchens stay around 1.5 m: at 1.95 m our island and stools looked squashed.
- **From a corner, on the diagonal,** or from the doorway. A frontal, symmetrical shot down the middle of the room reads as a render straight away.
- **Two-point perspective,** camera level, tilt never above 3 to 5 degrees. For exteriors from the ground you can write "shot on a tilt-shift lens, perfectly vertical lines".
- **Something close and out of focus,** like the edge of a door, a leaf or the back of a chair. It gives depth and tells the eye where the camera stands.

Light

One main source, with its direction, its hour and where the shadows go. Then the artificial lights, on or off as the hour says. Lamps on at noon are one of the first things people notice, even if they can't say what's wrong.

Light, day — Nano Banana Pro

Sun from the left at four in the afternoon, low and warm, long shadows across the oak floor toward the camera. The pendants are off. Soft haze on the hills far outside.

Light, night — Nano Banana Pro

Twenty minutes after sunset, the sky a deep blue over the city lights. The pendants and the floor lamp are on at 2700 K, warm pools of light on the stone; the glass reflects the room faintly.

Materials

Write the name of the material and how the light behaves on it. "Marble" is a default; "honed Breccia Medicea with violet, ochre and grey clasts, soft matte sheen" is a stone.

Stones

Breccia Medicea, Rosso Levanto, Verde Guatemala, Arabescato Orobico, Fior di Pesco Carnico, Grigio Carnico, Taj Mahal quartzite with a leathered finish, walnut-brown Noce travertine with open pores, Basaltina, honey onyx lit from behind.

Woods and metals

Fumed oak, bog oak almost black, book-matched burl walnut, Macassar ebony, oiled teak silvering at the edges, Brazilian ipe. Blackened steel, hammered bronze, brushed champagne bronze, unlacquered brass with patina.

Add the behaviour: "honed travertine with a soft matte sheen", "brushed bronze catching the warm light", "oiled teak silvering at the edges".

References few and real

- **Image 1 is always the 3D.** Write it in the prompt: "Image 1 is the 3D: keep the camera, the walls, the openings and the place of every piece."
- **Then one real flat sample per material,** each one named in its paragraph: "the floor as in image 2", "the wall as in image 3".
- **Never mood photos.** The model copies the whole picture, not the stone you liked in it. On a kitchen we gave it the client's mood photos and it gave us back a render.
- **Few references.** Too many and the building loses its structure: shutters, a gable, a staircase disappear.
- **Generated images are not references,** with one exception: the approved master view of the same project, used to keep the style.

The order of a prompt

1. **Camera:** type of shot, lens, height and position.
2. **Space:** what you see and how it is laid out.
3. **Materials:** one paragraph per material, with how the light sits on it.
4. **Light:** one main source, hour, direction of the shadows, lamps on or off.
5. **Life:** styling, at most one trace of life, people if you want them.
6. **Depth:** foreground, middle ground, background, light haze far away.
7. **Finish:** the closing line.

Full prompt · living room, Los Angeles

Nano Banana Pro · 3:2

Image 1 is the 3D: keep the camera, the walls, the openings and the place of every piece exactly as they are.
Interior photograph from the corner by the kitchen, 24 mm lens, camera at 1.6 m, two-point perspective with straight verticals. A living room 9 × 6 m with a dining table on the left and the seating area on the right, a glass wall to the hills on the far side.
Wide-plank fumed oak floor, oiled, deep honey-brown, as in image 2. A wall of book-matched Nero Marquina slabs floor to ceiling with a large black TV set into it and a low walnut cabinet floating underneath, as in image 3. A ceiling of fumed oak slats between dark plaster beams, 3.4 m high. Floor-to-ceiling glass in single uninterrupted panels, ultra-clear low-iron glass, slim dark bronze frames.
A long low sectional in charcoal heavy linen with crisp straight cushions. A low square coffee table in honed Verde Guatemala on a thin bronze plinth. Two brass ring pendants on long cables over the seating; a cluster of hand-blown glass globes on bronze rods over the dining table. The table tops are bare.
Sun from the left at four in the afternoon, long shadows across the floor toward the camera, the pendants off.
The back of the sofa close to the camera and out of focus, the room sharp, the hills and the city soft in the haze.
Editorial architecture photograph in the spirit of Joe Fletcher, natural colour like a Kodak Portra 400 film scan, gentle highlight roll-off, fine film grain.



Chapter 05

The check before sending an image

We look at every image in the same order before we send it. If one point fails we don’t touch the image: we write the prompt again with the fix inside and generate from zero.

The eight points always in this order

1. **Structure.** Is the building or the room the same as the 3D or the photos? Windows, doors, stairs and proportions in the right place.
2. **Geometry.** Vertical lines straight, two-point perspective, furniture at the right scale against doors and people.
3. **Light.** Shadows going one way, lamps that make sense for the hour, ceiling lights where there should be some, no candles.
4. **Reflections.** Glass, mirrors and polished stone reflect the scene that is really there.
5. **Materials.** Texture you can see, no plastic sheen. Tiles, joints and veins straight and not melting.
6. **Life.** The room looks lived in and complete. People, if there are any, with natural hands and faces.
7. **Fidelity.** The pieces of the project are identical to their references, and the client's past corrections are still there.
8. **Cleanliness.** No invented writing or logos, no particles, nothing the client already asked to remove.

The thirty-second scan for the AI's fingerprints

- Chair and table legs that are missing, doubled or melting into the floor.
- Lamps hanging from nothing, objects floating or fused together.
- Lines that stop halfway: a skirting, a shelf, a window frame.
- Shadows in two directions, lamps on at noon.
- Cloned palms, the same pattern repeated, the wrong scale.
- Turquoise water, an orange sky, an HDR look, edges sharpened by an upscaler.
- The default kit from chapter 2, and beige you didn't ask for.
- A new object in a corner that was empty in another view of the same room.

Never edit regenerate from zero

When an image is almost right, the instinct is to use it as a reference and ask for the one fix. Don't. Every edit drifts the picture a little, and after three edits the room has moved. Write the whole prompt again, describe in words what you liked, add the correction, and generate from zero. "Do the photo again" means exactly that.

Upscale only the one you keep

When the image passes all eight points, upscale it with Seedream 5.0 Pro: the good image as the only reference and a one-line prompt. If you use GPT Image instead, set it to 4K and quality high, because the default settings flatten the textures.

Prompt — Seedream 5.0 Pro

Upscale this image in quality, do not change anything else.

> The printable version of this check, with every point to tick, is the second extra that comes with the three playbooks together.



Chapter 06

How to price it our real price list

Here is our price list as it stands on omnyalab.com, with what every line includes and why it's built that way. Copy what fits your studio.

Images new views from your plans

Views	Price	Per view
1	€90	€90
10	€690	€69
20	€1,190	€60
30	€1,500	€50
12 a month	€599 a month	€50

Every pack includes two rounds of changes and 4K images in every format the client needs. From 10 views we add a free 10-second clip of the best view. The monthly plan gives 12 new views every month with delivery in 48 hours, for at least three months, and the views a client doesn't use move to the next month.

Virtual staging and retouch

Service	Price	What the client gets
Virtual staging	from €25	A photo of an empty room, sent back furnished and ready to be listed
Photo retouch	from €25	Light, materials or furniture changed on a photo or a render they already have

Films prices by length

Length	Price	Best for
30 s	€1,200	Reels and pitches
60 s	€2,200	Launch film
90 to 120 s	€3,900	Full launch film

Films are made from the approved images or from renders the client already has. Music, editing, colour grading and the reels for social media are always included.

What the market charges

Rendering prices vary a lot, so take any figure as a range. MyArchitectAI, a company that sells AI rendering, published a 2026 guide that puts a residential image between $250 and $2,800 and a commercial one between $450 and $10,000. It's a vendor's figure, but it shows how wide the market is and where a price like €90 a view sits.

Launch packages images and film together

Package	Price	What the client gets
Launch S	€2,900	8 images, 30-second film, 3 reels. In 5 days
Launch M	€4,900	15 images, 60-second film, 3 reels, presentation. In 1 week
Launch L	€8,900	25 images, 2-minute film, 6 reels, presentation. In 2 weeks

Prices are in euro and the same in every country, for standard work. A very complex project gets priced together before we start. Payment is a 50% deposit on confirmation and the balance on delivery, and the timings start from the deposit.

Why it's built this way

- **The first image is free.** The client sees the quality on their own project before paying anything. It costs us one image and it removes the biggest doubt.
- **The price per view drops with the pack.** A client who needs 20 views buys them at once, and you plan the work in one go.
- **Two rounds of changes, written down.** Unlimited changes is how a €690 job becomes a month of your time.
- **The film is sold by length,** because length is what the client understands. Everything that goes into it, from music to reels, is included and never priced as an extra.

What it's worth to the client

When you quote, start from what the images let the client do, which is to win the project, sell the units off-plan or get the approval, and then from your own costs: your plans on Claude and Higgsfield and your hours. Count the hours on your first ten images before you fix a price.

€1,860
that earned almost €100,000

Hygeia Grove, Corfu. The resort only existed on paper. With 24 images and a 90-second film, for €1,860, the architect presented it before the first stone was laid. His client fell for the story told in the film and gave him the project. The architect earned almost €100,000 from it, and construction has already started.

Now do it
on your own project

You have the method on paper. If you want to see it on your model, or skip the learning and get the images, here is what we can do.

Step	Price	What you get
Session, 60 min	€190	One to one on your project. You leave with your first image, the prompt file for your project and the recording.
Build, 3 hours	€490	The method set up on your Claude and Higgsfield accounts, 5 finished images of your project, one 10-second clip, the recordings and 7 days of questions on WhatsApp.
Done by us	from €90	You send the model or the plans, the first views arrive in 1 to 2 days. The first image is free.

Lessons are online, in English or Italian, on your own accounts, so everything stays yours after the call.

Book a lesson · omnyalab.com/learn

Send us your project · first image free

